

Research Proposal Approval Workflow

How a Principal Investigator's research proposal moves through internal institute endorsement, and — once endorsed — how the Research & Consultancy (R&C) office tracks its outcome with the funding agency. Endorsement by the institute is not the same as funding: an "Approved" proposal still needs the agency to actually sanction it before a Project is created.

Raised by Principal Investigator (Faculty)

Stages 8 in the internal chain, plus a post-approval agency-tracking phase

Terminal outcomes Sanctioned · Not Funded · Rejected · Withdrawn

PART 1 — INTERNAL ENDORSEMENT CHAIN

1 Draft

Forward to HOD

The PI drafts the proposal — title, agency, duration, budget lines, and the four mandatory submission documents — and forwards it into the chain. This is the PI's own stage; nobody else can act here.

2 With HOD

Forward

The Head of Department reviews and forwards. This step is scoped to the PI's own department — only that department's HOD sees it.

3 With R&C Office

Forward

Regular Staff, Superintendent, Deputy Registrar, or Dean can forward from here — the proposal has entered the central R&C office queue rather than a single named role.

4

Assigned to Dealing Assistant

Forward

The office assigns the file to a dealing assistant for processing before it goes up for signature. Same forwarding roles as the previous stage.

5

With Superintendent

Forward

Reject

The Superintendent can forward the proposal onward or reject it outright. Rejecting here returns the PI to **Returned to PI** rather than ending the proposal silently.

6

With Deputy Registrar

Forward

Reject

Same authority as the Superintendent: forward onward, or reject and send it back for revision.

7

With Dean

Approve

Reject

The Dean is the **only** role in this chain who can give final approval. Approving here closes out the internal chain; rejecting sends it back to the PI.

8

Approved

Terminal state for the internal chain. This means the institute has endorsed the proposal for submission to a funding agency — it does **not** mean money has been sanctioned yet. That happens in Part 2 below.

WHY A returned proposal re-enters at **Assigned to Dealing Assistant** (stage 4), not back at the top. The rule is deliberate: a correction does not need the HOD's endorsement or the Dean's judgment repeated — only the office processing that follows it. Re-entering at the Dean's own stage would also let a rejection loop back to the same desk that issued it.



Returned to PI (branch, not a numbered stage)

Revise & resubmit

Reached only when the Superintendent, Deputy Registrar, or Dean rejects. Only the PI can act here — they revise the proposal and resubmit, which jumps straight to **Assigned to Dealing Assistant**, skipping the HOD and Dean review that already happened.

ALSO AVAILABLE The PI may **withdraw** the proposal entirely at any point before it reaches **Sanctioned**.

PART 2 — AFTER INSTITUTE APPROVAL (AGENCY TRACKING, OUTSIDE THE WORKFLOW ENGINE)

Once a proposal reaches **Approved**, it leaves the formal stage-by-stage workflow. The R&C office instead tracks it against the funding agency directly:

A

Submitted to Agency

The R&C office records that the endorsed proposal has been sent to the funding agency. A 21-day countdown starts automatically from this point, and the office can extend it if the agency needs more time to decide.

B

Sanctioned

The office records the agency's sanction — sanction number, date, and total sanctioned amount. This is the **only** action in the entire portal that creates a Project: every budget line from the proposal becomes a budget head on the new project, landed entirely in Year 1 (years 2–3 start at zero and are redistributed later).

C

Not Funded

Alternatively, the office can record that the agency declined to fund the proposal. This is treated as a normal, non-error outcome — not every endorsed proposal gets funded, and the record reflects that honestly rather than as a failure.

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED

DOCUMENT	STATUS	PHASE
Cover Letter	Mandatory	Submission
Endorsement Certificate	Mandatory	Submission
Budget Copy (with overhead column)	Mandatory	Submission
Supporting Documents	Mandatory	Submission